

U1.1 Pronunciation Workshop

Spanish Sounds: Read It, Hear It, Say It

HSA High School Level 1 Lesson #01 supplement for Victor and Spencer. Use this packet with the website audio lesson; audio-linked sections are marked clearly.

A

[Listen online](#)

E

[Listen online](#)

I

[Listen online](#)

O

[Listen online](#)

U

[Listen online](#)

Learning goals

- ☐ Pronounce the five Spanish vowels with stable, short sounds.
- ☐ Say high-value consonant patterns clearly enough for a partner to recognize.
- ☐ Use audio to compare, repeat, and adjust pronunciation.
- ☐ Read a short supported story and answer comprehension questions.
- ☐ Create a Spanish-only identity card as a first transfer task.

My goal for this workshop

1. Five vowels, one steady sound each

Listen & practice online

Mouth cue



Keep vowels short and steady.
Do not stretch into English blends.

Spanish vowels are short and steady. Play the letter sound online, then practice each example word. Keep the sound clean instead of turning it into an English vowel blend.

Letter	Practice sound	Practice words
A	open a	mamá - casa - gracias
E	clear e	mesa - Elena - tres
I	clear i	mi - familia - sí
O	round o	hola - dos - profesor
U	round u	tú - uno - mucho

Vowel reminders I want to keep

2. High-value sound patterns

Every practice word has adjacent audio on the website. Listen once, repeat once, then read the row without audio.

Pattern	Practice words	Learner note
ñ	niño, español, mañana, señor	One special Spanish sound.
j / ge / gi	José, gente, gigante	Breathy sound; strength varies by region.
silent h	hola, hermano, ahora	Write h, do not pronounce it.
ll / y	yo, llamo, familia	Often similar in many regions.
r / rr	pero, perro, gracias	Single tap r; rolled rr develops over time.
qu	que, quiero, quince	Sounds like k before e or i.
gue / gui	Miguel, guitarra, guerra	Keep a hard g sound.
ce / ci / z	gracias, cinco, zapato	Latin America: s; much of Spain: th.

Pattern I want to remember

3. Reading: Dos hermanos, un día ocupado

Listen online: [full passage](#), [slow passage](#), [sentence playback](#)

Hola. Somos dos hermanos y vivimos en Washington.

Hello. We are two brothers, and we live in Washington.

Nos llamamos Victor y Spencer. Estudiamos en casa y también jugamos al hockey.

Our names are Victor and Spencer. We study at home, and we also play hockey.

Hoy tenemos un día ocupado. Por la mañana estudiamos matemáticas y español.

Today we have a busy day. In the morning, we study math and Spanish.

Por la tarde vamos a la pista de hielo. Victor lleva el número trece y Spencer practica con su equipo.

In the afternoon, we go to the ice rink. Victor wears number thirteen, and Spencer practices with his team.

Antes de salir, nuestra mamá pregunta: “¿Tienen todo?”

Before leaving, our mom asks, “Do you have everything?”

Victor dice: “Sí. Tengo mis patines.” Spencer mira su bolsa y dice: “Un momento... ¿dónde están mis guantes?”

Victor says, “Yes. I have my skates.” Spencer looks in his bag and says, “One moment... where are my gloves?”

Después de buscar un poco, los encuentra debajo de una silla. “¡Ahora sí!”, dice Spencer. Y todos salen de casa.

After looking for a little while, he finds them under a chair. “Now I’m ready!” says Spencer. And everyone leaves the house.

New words or story clues

4. Comprehension practice

Use multiple choice for harder recognition. Use short answers only where the answer can be retrieved from the passage.

1	¿Adónde van Victor y Spencer por la tarde?	A. A la biblioteca. B. A la pista de hielo. C. Al supermercado. D. Al parque.
2	¿Qué no encuentra Spencer al principio?	A. Sus patines. B. Su casco. C. Sus guantes. D. Su botella de agua.
3	¿Dónde están los guantes?	A. Dentro de la bolsa. B. Debajo de una silla. C. En el carro. D. Cerca de la puerta.

Short answers in Spanish

¿Dónde viven Victor y Spencer?

Write the answer from the passage

¿Qué estudian por la mañana?

Write the answer from the passage

5. Hockey choice: ¿Qué no quieres olvidar?

Listen online: each selected sentence has pre-made audio

Choose one item online. The website builds the correct sentence and plays the matching audio.

Item	English	Generated sentence
el casco	helmet	Oye, bro, ¿trajiste tu casco hoy?
los guantes	gloves	Oye, bro, ¿trajiste tus guantes hoy?
la botella de agua	water bottle	Oye, bro, ¿trajiste tu botella de agua hoy?
la ropa térmica	base layers	Oye, bro, ¿trajiste tu ropa térmica hoy?
los patines	skates	Oye, bro, ¿trajiste tus patines hoy?
el corazón de hierro	iron heart / mental toughness	Oye, bro, ¿trajiste hoy tu corazón de hierro?

El corazón de hierro significa tener fortaleza mental, resiliencia y estar listo para competir.

The iron heart means having mental toughness, resilience, and being ready to compete.

My game-day reminder

6. Mini Project: Mi tarjeta: Así soy yo

This project is Spanish-only. Use earlier lessons, a dictionary, or independent lookup. Do not add English to the finished card.

Optional online audio: [project prompts](#)

Me llamo _____.

Mi nombre se escribe _____.

Tengo _____ años.

Vivo en _____.

Me gusta _____.

Mi número favorito es _____.

Mi deporte favorito es _____.

Template choices

Passport / Travel • Sports Card • Notebook / Sketch • Modern Minimal

Design notes or words I want to look up

Parent / Instructor / Facilitator Reference

This is the single facilitator reference page for U1.1.

Goal

Build reliable pronunciation habits early enough that future vocabulary, reading, listening, and speaking become easier. Students do not need a native-like accent before moving forward.

Listen for

- | |
|----------------------------|
| • clear vowels |
| • silent h |
| • j / ge / gi |
| • ñ |
| • c / qu |
| • g / gu |
| • basic r / rr distinction |
| • predictable word stress |

Do not over-correct

Do not require a perfect rolled rr, one specific ll/y pronunciation, Spain's c/z pronunciation, accent imitation, or formal syllabification terminology.

Quick oral check

Ask the learner to read: casa, gente, hermano, queso, guitarra, niño, perro, música, español. Move on if the student can apply most major patterns, even if pronunciation is not perfect.